

Glossary of Techniques, Devices and Conventions used in English

Persuasive Techniques:

- Tone
 - See words to describe tone below
- Exaggeration/generalisation
 - Also known as hyperbole and meiosis
- Repetition
 - Creates emphasis
- Diction
 - Language used and word choice
 - See list on the right
- Structure
 - Structure both of the whole text and sentence structure
- Point of View
 - See table on points of view below
- Evidence
 - Hard evidence, such as statistics, expert opinions, photographs and factual information
 - Soft evidence, such as personal opinions and anecdotes
- Rhetorical questions
 - Gives the audience a sense of free will
- Figurative language
 - Simile, a comparison which uses 'like' or 'as'
 - Metaphor, a direct and literal comparison of two objects, which speaks of one thing in terms of another
 - Personification, the providing of non-living things with human or animalistic qualities
 - Imagery, a description that relates to the five senses; can be visual, aural, tactile, olfactory, (smell) or gustatory. (taste)

Language techniques

- Emotive
- Descriptive
- Colloquial
- Inclusive
- Value-laden terms
- Euphemisms (harsh reality more palatable)
- Name calling (Dysphemisms)
- Weasel words (may, might, can)
- Superlatives/comparatives (hyperbole)

Words to describe tone:

- Humorous
- Satirical
- Mocking
- Progressive
- Reflective
- Sarcastic
- Acerbic
- Biting
- Critical
- Serious
- Educated
- Friendly
- Depressing
- Sombre
- Dark/sinister
- Questioning

Types of POV	1st person (I, me)	2nd person (we, you, us)	3rd person (he, she, they)
Advantages	- Personal insight into author's experiences/emotions - Can create a plain folk appeal	Inclusive language	- Includes more opinions, objective - Greater perspective on the topic, sense of balance
Disadvantages	Potential for bias, subjective		

Narrative elements:

- Characterisation
 - Embody themes/attitudes
- Setting
 - Symbolic, i.e. classroom is a place of learning
- Plot/structure
 - Used to explore ideas
- Symbolism
 - Adding a deeper layer of meaning to an object
 - Strong emotional content
- Language*
- Point of view*
- * See above

Methods of persuasion derived from Aristotle's philosophy:

- Logos - an appeal to logic; uses a logically sound argument and hard evidence, such as stats, facts, expert opinions and photos
- Pathos - an appeal to the emotions of the audience; achieved through stimulating fear, anxiety, desire for inclusion, etc.
- Ethos - an appeal to the credibility of the corporation

Rhetorical Devices in Public Speaking:

- Allusion
 - Reference to a familiar person, place or event that is easily understood, in order to enrich or enhance the subject or to make meaning
 - Example: "Prepare for World War III if you take his parking spot."
- Analogy
 - A kind of extended metaphor or simile, in which a comparison is made between two things, one known and one unknown, to develop a line of reasoning or understanding
 - Metaphors and similes are generally more artistic and brief, whereas an analogy is longer and explains the thought process
 - Example: "Knowledge always desires increase; it is like fire, which first must be kindled, but which will afterwards propagate itself."
- Metaphor/simile
 - See above
- Anaphora
 - The repetition of the same word(s) at the beginning of successive phrases or sentences
 - Example: "I needed a drink. I needed a lot of life insurance. I needed a vacation. I needed a home in the country. What I had was a coat, a hat and a gun."
- Asyndeton
 - The lack of conjunctions between successive phrases or words
 - Example: "We shall pay and price, bear any burden, meet any hardships, support any friend, oppose any foe to assure the survival and the success of liberty."
- Chiasmus
 - A very effective technique where the clauses or words in one phrase are reversed in the next
 - Example: "The true test is not the speeches the president delivers, it's if the president delivers on the speeches."
- Climax
 - The arrangement of words or phrases in order of increasing importance or emphasis
 - Often used with parallelism to create a sense of continuity, order and upward movement in importance
 - Example: "And from the crew of Apollo 8, we close with good night, good luck, a merry Christmas, and God bless you all, all of you on the good Earth."

- Hyperbole/Meiosis
 - Hyperbole is the deliberate exaggeration for emphasis or effect
 - Example: "My parents will kill me if I'm not home before 12."
 - Meiosis is a deliberate understatement that can be used to soften the blow of harsh realities or to present the facts in a way that is beneficial to the speaker
 - Example: "The situation has developed not necessarily to our advantage."
- Parallelism
 - A figure of balance identified by successive words or phrases with identical or very similar grammatical structure
 - Example: "We shall pay and price, bear any burden, meet any hardships, support any friend, oppose any foe to assure the survival and the success of liberty."
- Tricolon
 - The use of words or phrases in threes
 - Example: "Government of the people, by the people, for the people."
 - Example: "Never in the history of human endeavour has so much been owed by so many to so few."

Types of appeals and techniques used in advertising:

- Testimonial
 - The use of celebrities, experts, (i.e. scientists) or 'normal' people to testify about the quality or value of the product.
 - Audience tends to believe them, as they appear to be a neutral third-party
 - The association of a product or service with a famous person
 - Use of scientific evidence
- Bandwagon
 - Creates the impression of widespread support
 - Plays on the human desire to be on the winning side and to not be left out, lonely or isolated
 - Simultaneously persuades people not on the bandwagon to jump on, and people on the bandwagon to stay aboard.
 - For example, a sense of majority belief can be established through the use of polls
- Card Stacking
 - The presenting of facts either partially or after giving a false context
 - Misleads the audience
- Transfer (juxtapositioning)
 - Carries over the authority and approval of something we respect and revere to something the advertiser wants us to accept
 - Symbols are often used
 - Example: The waving of an Australian flag to stir our emotions and win our approval, positioned behind a photo of a politician
- Flattery
 - "Because you're worth it"
- Humour
 - When we laugh, we feel good
 - Connection of good feeling to product
 - Hope is that when we see the product in future, we will remember the good feeling
- Fear (appeal to pathos)
 - Use of something that is disliked, such as failure, terrorism, high taxes to promote a 'solution'
- Explicit claims
 - "Works in just 5 minutes!"
- Novelty/nostalgia

- Feelings of excitement/good old days
- “Just like mum used to make”
- Extrapolation
 - Use of hyperbole to create fear or a slippery slope
 - Ignores the merits of small steps
- Ad hominem (against the man)
 - Attacks the messenger rather than their argument
 - Works on the belief that if the messenger is not virtuous or if there is something objectionable about them, their message must also be wrong
 - The straw man technique attacks a different idea that an opponent may (or may not) support that has been deliberately damaged
- Timing
 - Coinciding the advertising with events such as Valentine’s Day or a news report on terrorism
- Scapegoating
 - Extremely powerful in political speech
 - Blames a problem on one person, group, race, religion, etc.
- Cause versus correlation
 - The intentional relating of an idea and an outcome that are not connected
 - “Babies drink milk. Babies cry. Therefore, drinking milk makes babies cry.”
- Denial
 - Used to escape responsibility for something that is unpopular or controversial
 - A politician who says “I won’t bring up my opponent’s material problems” has just indirectly brought up the issue

Beliefs, Values and Attitudes

- A belief is a perceived link between any two aspects of a person’s world. We have thousands of beliefs.
- A value is a special kind of belief that endures and is very unlikely to change. Values are beliefs that prescribe and guide a person’s behaviour. A value can be a standard for behaviour (honesty, loyalty) or a desired end (success, power). Values are concepts of right and wrong, good and bad, desirable and undesirable.
- An attitude is the way a person responds to an idea, object, or course of action. It is an internal state of feeling towards, or an evaluative perspective to an idea, person or object. An attitude is a relatively enduring predisposition to respond; it is a value in action.

Still Image Conventions:

- Camera angles
 - Can be low, eye level, high, bird’s eye or worm’s eye
 - Symbolises power and importance, or lack of
- Body language, facial expression, gaze, stance, sight and position
 - Can convey the feelings, attitudes and/or the personality of the individual
- Composition
 - What is included is deliberately placed
 - Consider surroundings (setting), objects and clothing
- Colour, hue and tone
 - In B/W, examine the use of contrast, of light and darkness
 - In colour images, colour is often used symbolically to signify feelings and evoke a response
- Contrast
 - The arrangement of opposite elements (light and dark, large and small)

- Framing
 - Can be close up, extreme close up, medium shot, long shot, tilted up or down, etc.
- Omissions and cropping
 - What has deliberately been left out
 - Consider where the frame ends
- Orientation and point of view
 - Relates to framing and angle; audience can be positioned above the subject of the image, below it or at eye level (puts the audience on the same level)
- Positioning and juxtapositioning
 - Consider the foreground, middle ground and the background
 - Consider the proximity of symbols and objects
- Rule of thirds
 - Object in the top third can be empowered, whereas an object in the bottom third can be disempowered
- Salience
 - Focal point
 - The part the audience's eyes are first drawn to
- Symbolism
 - The use of an object to represent more complex ideas
- Vectors and leading lines
 - The lines that our eyes take when viewing an image